

"The pagans from the **northern regions** came with a naval force like **stinging hornets** and spread on all sides like fearful wolves."

—Simeon of Durham, medieval historian (1060-1129)

VIKING MYTHOLOGY



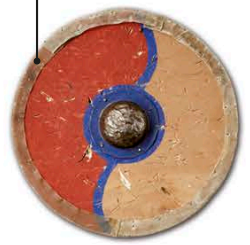
Vikings believed that gods and goddesses ruled nature and decided their fate. This carved stone shows Odin, the mightiest Norse god, riding his eight-legged horse. He resides in Valhalla, where fallen warriors are rewarded after death.



A sailor operates the steering oar to change the ship's course.

The ship's stern (back) and bow (front) are identical, which means it can reverse without turning around when rowed.

Shields were wooden with an iron center, which protected the hands from blows.



Circular shields

Viking shields were often painted in bright colors to show their owner's connection to a particular clan or leader. At sea, the shields were mounted along the side of the ship to protect the rowers and frighten enemies.

Long, slim oars power the ship through the water.